kept taking wickets and somehow found a way to stay in the contest, eventually dismissing us for 339.

There was a perceptible sense of irritation in our dressing room but, we thought, maybe it wasn't too bad. We should be OK. In the history of Test cricket at the Wanderers Stadium, no team had ever scored 310 in the fourth innings to win the match. The weight of history was on our side. We simply needed to bowl properly and hold our catches, and we did that on the fourth afternoon, with Vernon running in hard and dismissing Watson and Hughes, reducing Australia to 19 for two. Ricky Ponting and Usman Khawaja stuck around for a while but, after the latter fell to Imran's googly just before stumps, the tourists reached the close at 142 for three, with Ponting still fighting, unbeaten on 54, and Clarke on one not out.

Sporadic rain delayed the start of the fifth and final day, but the skies cleared and, after taking an early lunch, the umpires decided that play would start at 1 pm. We were impatient and excited. As a team and as individuals, we yearned for a home series win over Australia. Let's do this, Graeme said. Let's do this.

We could not have been more motivated and yet, when we eventually ran out to field, the stadium was almost deserted. Only a group of schoolboys was sitting on the grass bank in front of the changing room and our voices were echoing around the Bullring. It didn't matter. There was work to be done …

Vernon rumbled in and clean bowled Clarke. Morné had Ponting caught in the slips. Vernon trapped Mike Hussey LBW and the Australians seemed to be subsiding at 215 for six. Four more wickets, that's all we needed. But the Australians did not subside. Haddin and Johnson battled on, and reached tea at 222 for six, with 88 runs required.

All three results were possible. As the tension increased, the last session started with two boundaries off Philander and then two boundaries off Steyn. After almost five days of intense cricket, after so many twists